

Workplace Readiness Skills — Work Ethic

Standard 1.1.1 | Personal Qualities & People Skills | Sub Instruction Sheet

■ TO THE SUBSTITUTE — PLEASE READ BEFORE CLASS

Thank you for being here. This packet is completely self-contained — no subject matter expertise required. Your only job is to follow the three steps below, keep students working independently and quietly, and collect the student packets at the end of class. Everything else is handled by the materials.

Your Three Steps

STEP 1 — OPENING VIDEO (first 5–8 minutes, if a display and internet are available)

Search YouTube for: **"Harvard career coach unspoken rules getting promoted Big Think"**

Select the video by **Gorick Ng / Big Think** (approximately 6–7 minutes).

If technology is not available, skip this step entirely — the student packet is fully self-contained and works without the video.

STEP 2 — HAND OUT THE STUDENT PACKET

Distribute one printed student packet to each student. Tell them: *"Work through this independently and quietly. You will turn it in at the end of class."* Students work on their own for the remainder of the period. You do not need to explain the content — everything they need is in the packet.

STEP 3 — COLLECT AT THE END OF CLASS

Collect all student packets before students leave. The last page is an Exit Ticket — students may tear it off and hand it to you as they leave, or you may collect the full packet. Place everything on the teacher's desk.

■ OPTIONAL EXTENDER — If the teacher left Video Viewing Worksheets

A Video Viewing Worksheet for **"The Unspoken Rules for Getting Promoted"** may have been left with this packet. If printed copies are available, distribute them after the video plays in Step 1. Students complete the worksheet independently alongside the student packet. Collect all worksheets with the student packets at the end of class. If no worksheets were left, skip this — the student packet is sufficient on its own.

■ IF YOU HAVE EXTRA TIME

Ask for a volunteer to share one answer from the scenario section — no formal discussion required. Or allow students to review their responses quietly.

About this standard: Industry partners consistently rank Work Ethic as the #1 hiring factor — above technical skill. This standard covers punctuality, reliability, self-motivation, and willingness to go beyond the minimum.

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